

What is AaaS?

A short explainer for Pratikshya - read this first.

The one-line answer

*"AaaS is an **open-source accessibility layer** for Indian public institutions. It is Odia-first. Any college or government portal can plug it in and make their website usable for blind, deaf, and dyslexic students - in Odia."*

Think of it as **UPI, but for accessibility**. UPI is one shared system that every bank plugs into. AaaS is one shared system that every college and government portal can plug into.

Who it helps (remember these three names)

These are the three example users we keep coming back to in the demo and the pitch. Judges remember people more than they remember features.

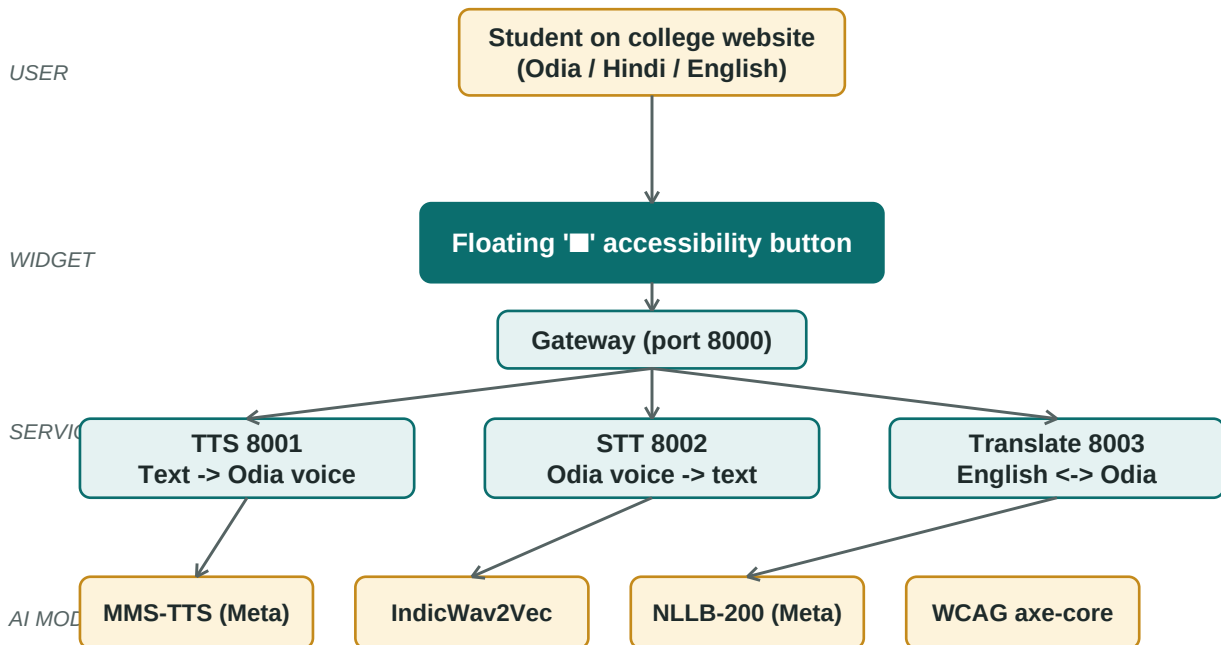
Priyanka	Blind, class 12 in Puri, speaks only Odia.	She fills an admissions form by speaking Odia into the widget.
Arun	Dyslexic, reads Odia.	He turns on Dyslexia Mode. Line spacing widens. Reading becomes easier.
Meera	Deaf, from Cuttack.	She watches the VC's Odia welcome video with auto-generated subtitles.

The three problems we solve

- **Accessibility is broken.** Nearly every college/government website in Odisha is hard to use for disabled students. Labels are missing, colours have bad contrast, keyboards don't work, captchas are images-only.
- **Odia is ignored.** Global tools support Hindi or English, but treat Odia as "other". We make Odia the *first* language, not a translation afterthought.
- **Every college re-builds it badly.** 200+ colleges in Odisha each try to fix accessibility alone. We make one shared layer everyone can plug into.

How it works (picture version)

Don't memorise every box. Just be able to point at the picture and say: "Student talks to the widget, widget talks to three services, services use open-source AI models - everything runs on the college's own server."



If a judge asks what MMS-TTS / NLLB / IndicWav2Vec are:

MMS-TTS (Meta) - turns text into Odia voice.

IndicWav2Vec (AI4Bharat) - turns Odia voice into text.

NLLB-200 (Meta) - translates between Indian languages and English.

axe-core - scans a website for accessibility mistakes.

You don't need to know the maths behind these. Judges rarely ask. If they do: "They are open-source models we picked because they work well on Indian languages - Odia especially."

Numbers to know cold

Memorise these five. They are the ones judges most often ask.

21 lakh+	Persons with disabilities in Odisha (2011 Census - real number higher).
42 million+	Odia speakers worldwide. 6th classical language of India.
200+	BPUT-affiliated colleges in Odisha. Plus 15+ state universities, 62,000+ schools.
WCAG 2.2 AA	The accessibility standard we follow (it's the global one).
Apache 2.0	Our open-source licence - anyone can use, modify, share.

The Odisha angle (important)

- Odisha has **5T** and **Mo Sarkar** - the state's own digital-service mandates. Accessibility is part of them. Use this phrase if the judge is from government.
- Run the pilot at **OCAC** (Odisha Computer Application Centre) - the state's IT agency. Everything runs on their servers. *Data never leaves Odisha.*
- Odia is a **classical language** (declared 2014). We handle Odia conjuncts correctly - which global tools get wrong.

One-line you can always fall back on:

"AaaS makes accessibility a **shared public layer**, like UPI - so every college in Odisha doesn't have to build it alone."